Interview ID: INT-02

Expert type: Architect

Name or anonymised role: Stanislav Tasev

Organisation: ST Architects

Date: 16/06/2026

Duration: 30 minutes

Format: In person

Permission to use interview notes with name and organisation: Yes

Interview purpose:
This interview collects design and specification knowledge about how architects understand window repairability, replacement, service life, spare-part information, supplier documentation, reuse barriers and environmental decision-making.

Consent note:
The participant gave permission for interview notes, including name and organisation, to be used in the project: Yes

Q1. When specifying windows in residential projects, which components do you usually think are most likely to fail first? / Когато специфицирате дограма за жилищни проекти, кои компоненти обикновено смятате, че се повреждат или износват първи?

Answer notes in Bulgarian:
Според интервюирания архитект, най-често първо се износват механизмите за отваряне и затваряне, включително механизмите за двустранно отваряне.

English explanation / interpretation:
The architect identified the opening and closing mechanisms as the components most likely to wear first, especially mechanisms that allow dual-mode opening. This supports the supplier interview and the literature pattern that early failures often occur in shorter-life functional components rather than in the full frame system.

Relevant codes:
Physical obsolescence / Technical obsolescence / Functional obsolescence / Maintenance / Component replacement

Q2. In practice, do you consider whether parts such as glazing units, seals, handles, hinges or fittings can be replaced separately? / На практика разглеждате ли дали отделни части като стъклопакети, уплътнения, дръжки, панти или обков могат да се подменят самостоятелно?

Answer notes in Bulgarian:
Според интервюирания архитект, възможността отделни компоненти да се подменят самостоятелно е от първа важност. Той посочи, че стъклопакети, уплътнения, дръжки, панти и обков могат да бъдат разглеждани като самостоятелно подменяеми елементи.

English explanation / interpretation:
The architect considered separate component replacement to be a key issue in window specification. This supports the project's focus on retaining long-life components while replacing shorter-life parts where possible. It also confirms that repairability is not only a supplier or installer issue, but also a design and specification concern.

Relevant codes:
Component replacement / Repair / Component accessibility / Design intervention / Maintenance planning

Q3. What information is usually missing when architects try to assess window repairability or future replacement? / Каква информация обикновено липсва, когато архитектите се опитват да оценят ремонтопригодността на дограмата или възможността за бъдеща подмяна на отделни компоненти?

Answer notes in Bulgarian:
Според интервюирания архитект, проблемът не е само в липсата на информация, а в това, че най-разпространената технология в практиката е трудна за бъдеща замяна или ремонт. Той посочи, че технологията с „черни каси“ би дала по-добра ремонтопригодност, но не е широко разпространена. Тоест информация съществува, но решенията, които биха улеснили ремонтопригодността, не се използват достатъчно често в практиката.

English explanation / interpretation:
The architect reframed the problem from a lack of information to a gap between known repairable solutions and common construction practice. The reference to "черни каси" can be understood as subframes or rough installation frames that may allow easier future removal or replacement. This suggests an implementation gap: repairable or more replaceable solutions may exist, but they are not commonly adopted in practice.

Relevant codes:
Implementation gap / Component accessibility / Design intervention / Repair information / Technical obsolescence / Lock-in

Q4. Do suppliers usually provide enough information about spare parts, maintenance, service life and warranties? / Доставчиците обикновено предоставят ли достатъчно информация за резервни части, поддръжка, експлоатационен живот и гаранции?

Answer notes in Bulgarian:
Според интервюирания архитект, ако такава информация бъде изискана, доставчиците могат да я предоставят и обикновено има достатъчно информация. Това означава, че част от проблема може да бъде свързан не само с наличието на информация, а и с това дали тя се изисква навреме и се включва в процеса на проектиране и спецификация.

English explanation / interpretation:
The architect stated that suppliers can provide enough information when it is specifically requested. This suggests that supplier information may exist, but may not automatically enter the design process unless architects or clients ask for it. For the project, this is important because repairability depends not only on product design, but also on information flow between supplier, architect and client.

Relevant codes:
Repair information / Spare parts / Supplier commitment / Lifecycle verification / Implementation gap

Q5. Why do clients or investors often prefer full replacement or new products instead of repair, refurbishment or maintenance? / Защо клиентите или инвеститорите често предпочитат нова дограма или цялостна подмяна вместо ремонт, обновяване или поддръжка?

Answer notes in Bulgarian:
Според интервюирания архитект, подмяната и ремонтът често са трудни, защото дограмата не е монтирана с „черни каси“. Когато дограмата е замонолитена в стената, отделните части или целият прозорец се подменят много по-трудно. Проблемът е свързан с липсата на използване на монтажни решения, които позволяват по-лесен бъдещ достъп, демонтаж или ремонт.

English explanation / interpretation:
The architect linked full replacement and repair difficulty to installation method and integration with the wall. If the window is effectively embedded or fixed into the wall assembly without a more accessible subframe strategy, later repair or replacement becomes more difficult. This supports the project’s argument that repairability depends on the building interface, not only on the window product itself.

Relevant codes:
Component accessibility / Disassembly / Implementation gap / Lock-in / Premature replacement / Design intervention

Q6. Can highly modular or high-performance window systems create extra cost, material complexity, detailing problems or future limitations? / Могат ли високоефективните или по-модулни прозоречни системи да създадат допълнителни проблеми, например по-висока цена, по-сложно детайлиране, повече материали, техническа сложност или бъдещи ограничения?

Answer notes in Bulgarian:
Според интервюирания архитект, такива системи могат да създадат допълнителни проблеми, най-вече поради по-високата цена. Поради тази причина често се избират по-евтини системи, които не са толкова добри. Той не посочи конкретни бъдещи ограничения, но отбеляза, че при всички случаи по-високоефективните или по-сложни системи използват повече материали и по-сложни механизми. В същото време те могат да имат по-дълъг живот и по-висока енергийна ефективност.

English explanation / interpretation:
The architect described a clear trade-off. More advanced or higher-performance systems may require higher initial cost, more material and more complex mechanisms, but they may also provide longer service life and better energy performance. This does not mean that such systems are automatically

worse; rather, their benefit depends on whether the added cost, material and complexity are justified over the lifecycle.

Relevant codes:
Higher initial material use / Increased material complexity / Lifecycle trade-off / Economic obsolescence / Upgrade / Lifecycle verification

Q7. What prevents removed windows or components from being reused in another project? / Какво най-често пречи свалени прозорци или отделни компоненти от дограма да бъдат използвани повторно в друг проект?

Answer notes in Bulgarian:
Според интервюирания архитект, възможността за повторна употреба зависи от конкретната дограма, но в България това не се среща често, защото няма широко използвани стандартни размери. Основният проблем е, че дограмата обикновено се прави по поръчка за конкретен отвор, което затруднява използването ѝ в друг проект.

English explanation / interpretation:
The architect identified the lack of standard window dimensions as the main barrier to reuse. Because windows are usually custom-made for specific openings, direct reuse in another project is difficult. This strongly supports the supplier interview and the case analysis, where made-to-measure dimensions were identified as a barrier to direct reuse.

Relevant codes:
Direct reuse / Standardisation gap / Service infrastructure / Disassembly / Certification / Implementation gap

Q8. Which design or specification decision most strongly affects future repairability? / Кое проектно или спецификационно решение според Вас най-силно влияе върху бъдещата ремонтопригодност на дограмата?

Answer notes in Bulgarian:
Според интервюирания архитект, стандартизацията на размерите е едно от решенията, които най-силно влияят върху бъдещата ремонтопригодност. Ако размерите на прозорците в една сграда са еднакви или по-стандартизирани, бъдещата подмяна, ремонт и обслужване могат да бъдат улеснени.

English explanation / interpretation:
The architect emphasised dimensional standardisation as a design decision that can improve future repairability and replacement. Standardised or repeated dimensions may make it easier to replace parts, source compatible products, reduce customisation barriers and potentially support reuse or more efficient maintenance planning.

Relevant codes:
Design intervention / Component accessibility / Standardisation / Maintenance planning / Direct reuse / Repair information

Q9. Have you seen a sustainable-looking window decision create an unexpected problem later, for example cost, maintenance, replacement, thermal performance or detailing issues? /

Виждали ли сте решение, което изглежда устойчиво или енергийно ефективно на етап проектиране, но по-късно създава неочакван проблем?

Answer notes in Bulgarian:
Интервюираният архитект не посочи конкретен пример за устойчиво или енергийно ефективно решение, което по-късно е създало неочакван проблем. Според него, ако проектирането е качествено и схемите са заложени правилно, не би трябвало да възникнат сериозни проблеми.

English explanation / interpretation:
The architect did not provide a direct example of a sustainable-looking window decision causing an unexpected problem later. His answer suggests confidence in careful design and correct specification. For the project, this should be treated as an absence of direct interview evidence for rebound or unintended consequences, not as proof that such problems cannot occur.

Relevant codes:
No direct example / Design intervention / Lifecycle verification / General unintended consequence not identified

Q10. What information would help architects make better decisions about window repair, replacement, service life and environmental impact? / Каква информация би помогнала на архитектите да взимат по-добри решения относно ремонт, подмяна, експлоатационен живот и екологично въздействие на дограмата?

Answer notes in Bulgarian:
Според интервюирания архитект, липсват достатъчно ясни задания към проектанта относно това какво точно иска инвеститорът. Възложителите трябва да бъдат по-добре запознати с процеса и да формулират правилно заданието, за да могат да се използват възможно най-добрите решения. Архитектът също посочи липса на законова стандартизация и ясни изисквания, които да насочват избора към по-добри решения за ремонтопригодност, експлоатационен живот и екологично въздействие.

English explanation / interpretation:
The architect emphasised the importance of a clear client brief and stronger regulatory or standardisation requirements. From his perspective, better decisions depend not only on technical information from suppliers, but also on whether clients understand the process and whether legislation or standards create clearer expectations. This expands the issue from product-level repairability to the wider decision-making system around architectural specification.

Relevant codes:
Client brief / Regulation / Standardisation / Policy intervention / Lifecycle verification / User guidance / Implementation gap

Additional notes from the interview:
The interview focused strongly on the relationship between repairability, installation method, dimensional standardisation and the quality of the design/specification process. The architect placed less emphasis on a lack of supplier information and more emphasis on the gap between available solutions and their actual use in practice.

Key takeaways:

1. The architect identified opening and closing mechanisms as the components most likely to wear first, which aligns with the supplier interview.
2. Separate component replacement is considered very important, especially for glazing units, seals, handles, hinges and fittings.
3. Repairability is strongly affected by installation method and the wall/window interface, especially whether the system allows future access, removal or component replacement.
4. The architect identified dimensional standardisation as a major condition for future repairability and possible reuse.
5. More advanced or high-performance systems may involve higher cost, more material and more complex mechanisms, but may also provide longer service life and better energy performance.
6. The interview highlights the importance of client briefs, regulation and standardisation, not only supplier information.

Possible MAXQDA codes:
Component replacement / Repair / Component accessibility / Disassembly / Design intervention / Maintenance planning / Repair information / Spare parts / Supplier commitment / Direct reuse / Implementation gap / Lock-in / Higher initial material use / Increased material complexity / Lifecycle trade-off / Regulation / Policy intervention / Lifecycle verification

Useful quote or paraphrase:
“Repairability depends not only on the window product, but also on how it is installed and whether future access or replacement has been considered.”

Follow-up needed:
No, unless further clarification is needed on the use of subframes, dimensional standardisation or how often architects request repair and maintenance information from suppliers.

Short post-interview summary:
This interview shows that architectural decisions strongly affect the future repairability of residential window systems. The architect emphasised that mechanisms are often the first components to wear, and that separate replacement of glazing units, seals, handles, hinges and fittings is important. However, repairability is often limited by common installation practice, especially when windows are embedded into the wall assembly without solutions that allow easier future access or replacement. The interview also highlights dimensional standardisation, clearer client briefs and stronger regulatory requirements as important conditions for improving repairability, reuse potential and lifecycle decision-making.